The Miracle of the Fig Tree: The Story of Ahmet Cemal

The Difficult Days: August 1974 The date is August 15, 1974. There is a war in Cyprus. In a village called **Taşkent (Dohni)**, Turkish and Greek people live together. But one day, soldiers come to the village. They take all the Turkish men and boys. They put 69 men on buses. The soldiers say, "We are going to a camp." But the men never come back. For many years, their families wait, but there is no news.

The Search for Missing People In 1981, a group called the **Committee on Missing Persons (CMP)** is started. It has three members: one Turkish, one Greek, and one from the United Nations. For a long time, they cannot find anyone.

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But later, a Swedish man named Christophe Girod and a Greek man named Ksenofon Kallis start to work very hard together.

The Lonely Tree One day in 2011, the team sees a **fig tree** near the village of Pareklişa. This is very strange because the ground is only rocks and stones. There are no other trees nearby. Kallis wonders, "How can a tree grow here alone?"

The Discovery The team visits many families. They learn about **Ahmet Cemal**. In 1974, he left his home and said, "I am going to the fig garden." He never returned. The team decides to dig under the lonely tree. Under the roots, they find the bones of three people.

The Miracle of the Seed How did the tree grow there? Before Ahmet Cemal died, he ate a fig. After he was buried, the **seed** in his stomach grew. It became a big tree over many years. That tree showed the world where he was.

The Final Rest The team continues to dig and they find a large grave. They find 34 Turkish men from Taşkent. After DNA tests, these men finally return home. They are buried with a big ceremony at the new **Taşkent Martyrs' Cemetery** in Girne. After 40 years, they are finally at peace.